

Justina Wang

PhD Student in Computer Science & Learning Sciences

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EDUCATION

Northwestern University <i>Ph.D. in Computer Science and Learning Sciences</i> Advisor: Dr. Matthew Easterday	Evanston, IL 2025-present
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University of Wisconsin-Madison <i>B.S. in Computer Science, Minor in Educational Studies</i> Graduated with Honors in Computer Science	Madison, WI 2022-2025
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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Northwestern University <i>Graduate Research Assistant, advised by Dr. Matthew Easterday</i> Designing, iteratively developing, and field-evaluating sociotechnical systems to support undergraduate students in project-based learning environments	Evanston, IL 2026-Present
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University of Wisconsin-Madison <i>Research Assistant, advised by Dr. Bilge Mutlu</i> - Assisted in designing and building software for after-school informal learning with intelligent robot tutors - Designed and led a complete two-phase research project on multi-lingual co-reading interfaces as my senior honors research thesis. Conducted two phases of participant interviews, a think-aloud user study, and complete qualitative analysis.	Madison, WI 2023-2025
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PUBLICATIONS

Hui-Ru Ho, Bengisu Cagiltay, **Justina Wang**, Rabia Ibtasar, Bilge Mutlu, and Joseph E Michaelis. 2026. Exploring Student Perspectives on Interacting with Social Robots for Homework. In Proceedings of the 25th Annual ACM Interaction Design and Children Conference (IDC '26).

HONORS & AWARDS

Northwestern University HCI+D Design Research Cluster Fellowship (~\$47,000)	2026
Northwestern University Computer Science Student Organization of the Year Award	2026
Honors for Undergraduate Thesis in Computer Science	2025
Dean's Award, UW-Madison College of Letters and Sciences	
Trewartha Senior Thesis Research Grant (\$1,500)	2024
Wisconsin Science and Computing Emerging Stars (WISCERS)	2023

SERVICE

Peer Reviewing

- ACM Conference on Human Factor in Computing Systems 2026
- Interaction Design and Children Conference 2026

Co-Organizer of Northwestern CS PhD Orientation Day 2026

Co-Organizer of Northwestern CS PhD Visit Day 2026

Board member of Northwestern CS PhD Advisory Council (CSPAC) 2025-Present

Board member of the Computer Science Social Initiative (CSSI) 2025-Present

Board member of ACM's Women in Computing at UW-Madison 2023-2025

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Community Wheelhouse Remote

Business Technology Consultant June 2025-Aug 2025

- Engineered end-to-end automations connecting Airtable and Jotform for an affordable housing company's client intake and case management, eliminating manual data entry and reducing processing time for applications.
- Developed an AI-powered chatbot to handle routine client inquiries

Kohl's Technology San Ramon, CA

Software Engineering Intern June 2024-Aug 2024

- Enhanced and optimized the reliability and scalability of the transactional email systems for internet customers. Technical stack includes Java Spring Boot, Postman, MongoDB, Salesforce, and Kafka.
- Designed, prototyped, and launched a generative AI powered email template engine for Kohl's engineers. This engine converts natural language emails into reusable templates with embedded Salesforce Merge Language. Tools include Python, Sklearn, Pandas, Gradio and OpenAI API.